

TERRY UWAGBAE OKO-ODION

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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (Hons)

2024

Ambrose Alli University, Nigeria

GRE: 337/340 (Quant: 170, Verbal: 167)

- **Relevant coursework:** Artificial Intelligence, Machine Learning, Data Science, Cybersecurity, Network Security, Software Engineering, Database Systems

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

September 2025 – Present

AI for Food Allergies (Hugging Face Science)

- Engineered a balanced distribution strategy for the Goldberg microbial signature dataset (700+ samples) to prevent the model from learning spurious temporal correlations
- Restructured clinical metadata for 233 individuals by resolving ambiguous SRS IDs and inconsistent temporal labels, ensuring causal integrity for the binary classification of IgE-mediated food allergies
- Collaborating with domain experts to define clinically rigorous evaluation metrics that prioritize worst-case safety over average-case accuracy in high-stakes healthcare diagnostics

Independent Researcher

October 2025 – Present

Machine Learning Collective

- Co-leading an audit of the XNLI benchmark for 11 African languages, engineering a data pipeline to scale test sets by 800% (from 600 to 5,010 samples per language) to ensure statistical reliability in model evaluation
- Investigating evaluation brittleness in LLMs (GPT-4, Claude-3.5, Llama-3), quantifying how small-sample benchmarks mask performance gaps between English and low-resource African languages
- Analyzing performance variance across different model architectures to determine the stability of current leaderboards for under-represented languages

Researcher

July 2025 – Present

AI4Africa

- Co-developing the first large-scale, multi-dialectal Yoruba language model, designing architectural modifications specifically tailored for efficient inference in low-resource computational settings
- Curating novel evaluation datasets, including Yoruba Q&A pairs, to move beyond translation-based metrics and test models on culturally grounded reasoning task
- Collaborating within a distributed research team to standardize data collection protocols, ensuring high-quality representation of diverse Yoruba dialects in the pre-training corpus

Independent Project

Ongoing

- Evaluated confidence calibration in medical LLMs (MedAlpaca-7B, Llama-3) on the AfriMed-QA dataset to measure trustworthiness in low-parameter models
- Applied Self-Ensembling to mitigate overconfidence and measured performance using the Ethical Confidence Index (ECI) and TH-Score

Undergraduate Thesis Research

April 2023 – Aug 2023

Ambrose Alli University, Department of Computer Science

- Designed and implemented a web-based academic repository, focusing on data integrity as the foundational layer for trustworthy AI
- Engineered a structured metadata schema and validation pipelines to ensure data consistency and combat incompleteness bias
- Implemented access controls and audit trails to establish clear data provenance, a critical requirement for accountable AI systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Research Computing: Python (PyTorch, TensorFlow, NumPy, Pandas, Scikit-learn), Statistical Analysis & Data Visualization, SQL Databases & Web APIs for Data Collection, Git Version Control & Docker Containerization

Machine Learning Research: Deep Learning & Neural Networks, Model Evaluation & Benchmark Design, Data Preprocessing & Feature Engineering, Experimental Methodology & Statistical Testing

CONFERENCES

International Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Robotics (ICAIR), MIRG, **University of Lagos**

Nov. 2025

PUBLICATION & MANUSCRIPTS

- Anuj Tiwari, Oluwapelumi Ogunremu, **Terry Oko-odion**, Hannah Nwokocha, and Jesujuwon Egbewale.
"Evaluating Prompting Strategies for African Languages in Low-Resource NLP."
Under review at the LoResLM Workshop (EACL 2026)
- Anuj Tiwari, Oluwapelumi Ogunremu, **Terry Oko-odion**, Hannah Nwokocha, and Jesujuwon Egbewale.
"Sample-Size Scaling of the African Languages NLI Evaluation."
Under review at the AfricaNLP Workshop (EACL 2026)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- **National Information Technology Development Agency (NITDA)**
3MTT Fellow, 2024
- **Innovative Leadership Award**
National Association of Physical Science Students (NAPSS) AAU, 2023
- **Matthew Okpebholo Foundation Annual Scholarship, 2023**

LEADERSHIP AND VOLUNTEERING

- CoreTeam and Mentor** July 2023 – July 2024
Google Developer Student's Club, AAU
- Organized AI training, delivered training on Git/GitHub and web development, mentored students, and led campus tech outreach initiatives
- Director of Information** Dec 2022 – Dec 2023
National Association of Physical Science Student(NAPPS), AAU
- Streamlined communication channels and launched a social media community for improved student–faculty engagement
- Volunteer** June 2022
MTN Y'ello Care
- Promoted digital literacy and cybersecurity awareness in underserved communities. Delivered training on safe internet practices, password management, and responsible use of technology, and engaged students in hands-on tech activities to encourage interest in STEM fields

TEACHING

- Teaching Assistant** 2021– 2023
Department of Computer Science
- Operations Research (BLD401), Intro to Computer Science (CSC101), and Artificial Intelligence (CSC305)
 - Graded assignments and mentored students in programming fundamentals

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- IT Support** Apr. 2025 – Present
RT Briscoe Nigeria Plc, Lagos
- Manage IT infrastructure, coordinate system upgrades, and lead cybersecurity awareness.
- Software Developer Intern** Feb. 2024 – Dec. 2024
Rovadana, (Part-time & Remote)
- Developed APIs and backend systems; contributed to full software lifecycle in web applications.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Machine Learning Specialization**
Stanford University & DeepLearning.AI, (2025)
- **Responsible AI and Ethics**
Johns Hopkins University, (2025)

MEMBERSHIP

- Machine Learning Collective (MLC)
Black in AI
Data Science Nigeria (DSN)
Nigeria Association of Computing Student(NACOS)